

Single Source Justification (Simplified Acquisition)

Section A: General Contract Information

Is this a Bridge Action as defined in the [AF Bridge Action Reduction Plan](#)? ☐ Yes ☒ No

Contracting Activity: 763 Enterprise Sourcing Squadron (763 ESS)

Project/Program Name: EACN Software Licenses

Purchase Request / Local ID Number: [REDACTED]

Estimated Contract Cost (including Options): [REDACTED]

Section B: Description of the Supplies/Services Required

Palo Alto is a virtual (software) firewall that supports EACN's 10 gigabit architecture and enhances customer connection ability. Palo Alto Next Generation Firewall (NGFW) Credits for VM-Series that includes Threat Prevention subscription, US Government Premium Support, 1 year, Renewal Service Duration: 12 Months

Section C: Justification for Soliciting from a Single Source or Brand Name

In order to choose a firewall vendor that met EACN's needs, the following salient characteristics were sought after:

- Virtual appliance - In order to rapidly deploy firewalls and ensure minimal downtime during maintenance windows, the vendor must provide a virtual deployment option
- Single management pane - The deployment must support a single management solution to control all subordinate firewalls across our three sites from a centralized location
- Next Generation Firewall - These devices supporting EACN must meet next-generation firewall standards, including deep-packet inspection, malware detection, and application awareness, all from a single appliance.

After carefully considering other vendor solutions, only Palo Alto's Next-generation firewalls managed by Palo Alto Panorama met the above requirements to protect our user's traffic. Cisco's firewall software lacked the advanced threat prevention features needed. Juniper Networks' solution didn't offer the same scalability and performance as Palo Alto's. Fortinet's product failed to integrate seamlessly with existing network architecture.

Palo Alto's firewalls currently play a key role in inspecting and protecting our customer's traffic. Implementing an alternative solution would require a complete redeployment and redesign of the EACN architecture. Resulting in significant downtime to senior leader aircraft, \$40K and 8 weeks additional training cost, \$600K and 700 hours of engineering, and a significant increase in operational risk.

Palo Alto is required to maintain our current security posture within EACN by renewing our licenses for both Panorama and the Firewall virtual machines. Without these licenses, the security posture of EACN and the VIPs it supports would be significantly compromised, presenting a larger attack surface for potential cyber threats. A gap in support could cause a network interruption in both communications service and security, as well as a lack of system support would delay any attempt to recover from a disaster scenario.

Additionally, Palo Alto brand licenses are the only brand certified for EACN use. The process to certify another brand of licenses requires significant time and resources that no other vendor has completed at this time. Therefore, no other brand will meet the Government's requirement.

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Section D: Efforts to Obtain Competition

Based on the market research conducted, it was determined that the required BNO Palo Alto licenses are not available on any ordering vehicle. Therefore, the 763d determined that this requirement will be posted to SAM.gov as a combined synopsis/solicitation in accordance with FAR 12.603.

A sources sought was posted on SAM.gov and received nine responses, indicating sufficient competition amongst authorized resellers for this Brand Name requirement.

Section E: Steps to Preclude Future Single Source or Brand Name Awards

Barriers to competition consist of the government's limited ability to secure maintenance support for Palo Alto equipment and/or software provided by any source other than Palo Alto or Palo Alto authorized re-sellers. The government will continue to examine the marketplace for alternative viable solutions for future acquisitions.

Section F: Contracting Officer's Determination

I have determined, in accordance with [FAR 13.106-1\(b\)\(1\)](#), that the circumstances of this contract action deem only a single source is reasonably available.

Date	Typed Name and Rank/Grade of Contracting Officer	Signature of Contracting Officer
16-Oct-2025	Jordan J. Butler, Maj	BUTLER.JORDAN.J.1467676 675 Digitally signed by BUTLER.JORDAN.J.1467676675 Date: 2025.10.16 14:29:35 -05'00'